OPERATIONS AND FUNDING PLAN

Snap Map NYC launch and funding playbook

What is now in the site, and the order to do everything else in: legal, analytics, the first 90 days, the sponsorship ask, the money mechanics, and the expansion that is worth doing.

Prepared for the owner of snapmapnyc.com · November 8, 2026 · Not legal or tax advice

The site already works. The missing pieces were the boring ones that funders and partners check before they take a project seriously: a privacy notice, terms, an editorial independence policy, a way to count visits without surveilling anyone, and a one-pager a program officer can read in three minutes. Those are now built. This document is the order to use them in.

What was added to the repo

FILE	WHAT IT IS
`public/terms.html`	Terms of use: informational only, no warranty, liability cap, acceptable use, credits, New York law.
`public/privacy.html`	Plain-language privacy notice covering the three things that actually leave a browser: Nominatim lookups, GitHub Pages logs, and cookieless analytics.
`public/sponsorship.html`	Sponsorship and editorial independence policy: what money buys, and the list of things it never buys.
`public/accessibility.html`	WCAG 2.2 AA target, what is done, known gaps, and how to report a barrier.
`public/partners.html`	Printable one-pager for nonprofits, hospitals, health plans, and funders: the gap, the audience, three support levels, what gets reported back.
`public/legal.css`	Shared styling for those pages, with a print stylesheet.
`src/lib/analytics.js`	Cookieless GoatCounter loader plus `trackEvent`. Off unless configured, and never loaded for Do Not Track or Global Privacy Control.
`src/components/Footer.jsx`	Links to all five pages, plus the wording that says the site is not run by the City or State and is not affiliated with USDA or OTDA.
`.env.example`, `.github/workflows/pages.yml`	One place to set the analytics site code locally, and a repository variable hook for deploys.

One thing to fix before you publish: the contact address on all five pages is `hello@snapmapnyc.com`. Either set up mail forwarding at your registrar, or replace it with an address you check. A legal page with a dead contact address is worse than no page.

Phase 0: before the next deploy (this week)

About 3 hours, plus waiting time on the legal review.

- ☐ **Fix the contact address.** All five pages, plus the footer of the app. Set up forwarding at your domain registrar, or swap in a real mailbox.
- ☐ **Read the four legal pages out loud and correct anything that is not true.** Check the effective date, the description of the data source, and the "current sponsors" section. These are your words, not a template's.
- ☐ **Create the analytics account.** Sign up at goatcounter.com, choose a site code (for example `snapmapnyc`). Free for reasonable public, non-commercial use.
- ☐ **Turn it on.** Locally: copy `.env.example` to `.env` and set `VITE_GOATCOUNTER_CODE`. On GitHub: repository Settings, Secrets and variables, Actions, Variables, new variable with the same name. Then push and redeploy.
- ☐ **Prove it works.** Visit the live site, then check the GoatCounter dashboard for one pageview. Open the browser console and confirm no cookie is set. In GoatCounter settings, exclude your own IP so your own visits do not inflate the numbers.
- ☐ **Check the live links.** Load snapmapnyc.com, scroll to the footer, and click all five pages. They are plain files in `public/`, so they must return 200, not 404.
- ☐ **Get one hour of legal review.** A law school clinic, a solo attorney, or a nonprofit legal panel. Ask specifically about three things: the liability cap, the governing law clause, and whether the privacy notice accurately describes Nominatim and the analytics. Budget $0 to $1,200.
- ☐ **Check the source terms.** Find the terms attached to the state list you built `restaurants.json` from. Public records are usually reusable, but confirm, and note it in the credits if a condition applies.
- ☐ **Deploy.** Push to `main`. The workflow builds and publishes.

> **Do not skip this:** the site is allowed to be free to run, but the budget you show a funder must include your hours. A zero-labor budget reads as "this will be abandoned," and it is the most common reason a tiny civic project gets declined.

Phase 1: weeks 1 to 8, earn the numbers

Do not pitch until you have roughly two months of data. A live site with real usage is the strongest paragraph in any proposal; a built site with no users is a hard sell to a stranger.

Get the site in front of people

- Print the partner one-pager (`partners.html`) and a simple card with a QR code to the site. Hand cards to 10 pantries, libraries, senior centers, and FQHC waiting rooms.
- Ask three community organizations to link to it from their food access page. Offer to write the two sentences for them.
- Post once in each borough's subreddit and in mutual aid groups, framed as a tool, not a fundraiser. Answer questions in the thread.
- Add a one-line "last verified" date to the site footer (for example "List checked against the state list on November 8, 2026"). It is the cheapest possible signal that maintenance is real.

Measure these, weekly, in one spreadsheet

METRIC	WHERE IT COMES FROM	WHY A FUNDER CARES
Visits and unique visitors	GoatCounter dashboard	Reach, the first number anyone asks for.
Address and location lookups	`nearby-lookup`, `use-my-location` events	Proof that people are actually searching, not just landing.
Directions and call clicks	`directions`, `call` events	Intent to go. This is the closest thing to a meal outcome.
Top boroughs and ZIP codes	GoatCounter country/city and path data	Lets a borough sponsor see their own district in the numbers.
Share of mobile visits	GoatCounter	Justifies the no-app, low-bandwidth design.
Emails and requests received	Your inbox	Qualitative evidence that institutions want this.

Translation is the highest-value thing you can do next

The audience is heavily Spanish-speaking, and the site is English-only. A native-speaker review of the interface and the four program explanations is both a real user benefit and a line item funders understand. Do not machine-translate the legal pages and call it done; have a person read them.

Phase 2: weeks 8 to 12, the ask

Who to approach, in order

1. **FQHCs and hospital community benefit offices.** In New York, nonprofit hospitals must document community health spending, and food insecurity is a standing priority in many of their community health needs assessments. Your tool is a cheap, reportable line in that document. Ask for the community benefit or population health office, not marketing.
2. **Anti-hunger and food access nonprofits.** The ones already doing SNAP outreach. They can pay a small sponsorship, or, more often, they can carry you as a subawardee on a grant they are already writing. Ask which proposals are open.
3. **NYC Council discretionary funding.** Find the council member for the district with the most listings and the most visits, and ask about a member item. Small civic projects are funded this way, but the process is annual and usually needs an organization to receive the money.
4. **Borough presidents and community foundations.** Smaller amounts, less process, good for a first check.
5. **Medicaid managed care plans.** Real budgets, but state marketing review slows everything down. Approach only if you have patience and a named contact.

What a good ask contains

- One page, one number, one deliverable, one reporting promise.
- A specific use of funds: "one verification pass over 235 listings," not "support the site."
- Two months of real numbers, and the sentence "here is what we would do with your money."
- A link to the sponsorship policy, so they can see you will not sell placement.
- A start date and a renewal date, so it is a decision they can make once a year.

Opening email, 150 words

> Subject: Free EBT restaurant map, and a small ask
>
> Hi [Name] — I run Snap Map NYC (snapmapnyc.com), a free map of the 235 New York City restaurants that accept EBT through the Restaurant Meals Program. It needs no app, no account, and sets no cookies. In the last [N] weeks, [X] people used it to search near an address, and [Y] clicked through for directions.
>
> I am looking for [$500] from [Organization] to cover [a full re-verification of every listing against the current state list] this year. Sponsors are named on the site, never in the listings, and money does not affect ranking or inclusion — the policy is here: [link].
>
> Would a 15-minute call in the next two weeks make sense? Happy to send the one-page summary first.
>
> — [Name], [phone]

Follow-up rhythm

Day 5: forward the same note with the one-pager attached. Day 12: one line, "closing the loop on this." Then stop and put them on a quarterly update list. Most first-time civic sponsorships are won on the second or third contact, not the first.

> **Pricing guardrail:** $500 is a fine first number because it buys a concrete deliverable. Do not go below what the work costs you in hours. If an organization cannot pay, ask for in-kind help instead: data sharing, translation review, printing, or a desk at their outreach events.

Phase 3: money mechanics

Entity

Stay a sole proprietor for now. You can invoice as an individual with a W-9. A New York LLC requires newspaper publication for six weeks, which commonly runs into four figures in the city, and that is a bad first expense for a project earning a few thousand a year. Revisit the LLC when you sign a contract with real liability or start paying others.

If a funder requires 501(c)(3) status, use a fiscal sponsor rather than incorporating. They receive the grant, take 5 to 10 percent, and you keep your independence. Ask a community organization you already work with, or a fiscal sponsorship intermediary.

Paperwork

- Get an EIN (free, online, minutes). Use it instead of your Social Security number on W-9s.
- Open a separate checking account for the project. Never mix it with personal spending.
- Invoice fields: your name and address, EIN, invoice number, date, "Sponsorship of Snap Map NYC, [period]", amount, payment terms (net 30), and a line naming the deliverable.
- Track hours from day one. It is your budget justification next year.
- Set aside 25 to 30 percent of every check for taxes, and pay quarterly estimated taxes. A sponsorship is taxable self-employment income; it is not a gift.
- Keep receipts for domain, printing, hosting, and any contractor. They are deductible against the income.

What to put in a one-page sponsorship agreement

- Scope and deliverable, with dates.
- Amount, payment schedule, and what happens if the project stops (refund the unearned part).
- How the sponsor is credited, and the sentence that credit does not imply endorsement.
- Editorial independence: no approval over content, listings, or ranking.
- Data: aggregate reporting only, no visitor-level data because none exists.
- Term, renewal, and either side's ability to end it with 30 days' notice.

Phase 4: expansion, but only in this order

More public benefit data is a good idea because funders fund benefits access, not restaurant maps. It is also where small civic projects die, because stale hours destroy trust faster than a missing feature. The rule for every new layer: a maintained source, a visible verification date, and a named owner. If you cannot get all three, link out instead of embedding it.

LAYER	SOURCE	WHY NOW OR LATER
EBT farmers markets and Health Bucks	GrowNYC, NYC Open Data	High value, seasonal but predictable. Do this first.
SNAP enrollment help nearby	Public CBO lists	Static, low churn, and it turns the site into a benefits tool.
Food pantries and free meals	Food Help NYC, HRA	Only with a maintained feed and verification dates. Hours change weekly.
EBT museum and culture discounts	Individual institutions	Different category. Interesting, but it drifts from the food mission.

Do not add reviews, wait times, prices, or crowdsourced edits. They need moderation you do not have, and they invite the one thing you cannot afford: confidently wrong information about food.

Phase 5: the path that actually pays

Sponsorship is coffee money. The same codebase, packaged, is worth several times more per sale. The hand-drawn map, the no-API-key approach, the stateless search, and now the legal templates and the partner one-pager are a reusable kit for any city or county with a Restaurant Meals Program or a food access map.

- **Who buys:** food policy councils, anti-hunger coalitions, cooperative extension programs, county health departments, and state agencies that need a contractor.
- **What you sell:** a branded instance with their data, their borough or county shapes, deployment, and a handover. Keep the NYC site yours and independent.
- **Price:** $2,000 to $10,000 per instance depending on data work, or $75 to $150 an hour. Say the number plainly; civic buyers expect a budget, not a donation request.
- **Disclose conflicts:** if a sponsor also becomes a client, say so on the site.

Guardrails that protect the whole thing

- **Never imply government endorsement.** No USDA, SNAP, OTDA, HRA, or City marks. Keep the non-affiliation sentence in the footer on every page, including the new ones.
- **No pay-for-placement, ever.** One exception would end your credibility with every funder you have.
- **No user data, no ads, no affiliate links.** Especially not to delivery services on a SNAP audience.
- **Respect the Nominatim policy.** One request per visitor action, never on keystrokes, identifiable Referer and User-Agent, attribution in the footer. Bulk geocoding goes through the Census geocoder at build time, as you already do.
- **Show your freshness.** A verification date, and an easy way to report a wrong listing. Wrong hours are the fastest way to lose a user forever.
- **Audit accessibility before pitching institutions.** Hospitals and city agencies ask. Your statement already sets the target honestly; get an independent check when you can afford one.

90-day checklist

Days 1 to 7

☐ Contact address fixed

☐ Legal pages read and corrected

☐ GoatCounter account and site code

☐ Analytics verified, own IP excluded

☐ Live footer links checked

Days 31 to 60

☐ Spanish review of the interface quoted

☐ Full re-verification pass done

☐ "Last verified" line added

☐ 5 target organizations identified

☐ Partner one-pager sent to each

☐ Deployed to production

Days 8 to 30

☐ One hour of legal review booked
☐ Source list terms confirmed
☐ 100 QR cards printed
☐ 10 sites visited or mailed
☐ 3 organizations asked to link
☐ Weekly metrics sheet started

Days 61 to 90

☐ 15-minute calls held
☐ First sponsorship invoice sent
☐ W-9 and separate account ready
☐ Quarterly tax set-aside started
☐ Decision on farmers market layer

Appendix: the numbers to keep in front of you

LINE	YEAR ONE, LOW	YEAR ONE, REALISTIC
Domain and hosting	$15	$15
Analytics	$0	$0
Legal review (one hour)	$0	$600
Printing (cards, one-pagers)	$50	$250
Spanish review and translation	$0	$700
Verification labor (your hours)	$600	$2,400
Accessibility audit	$0	$1,500
Total to raise	**~$665**	**~$5,465**

The low column is the honest minimum to keep the site correct for a year. If you raise less than that, the list starts to rot, and the product stops being worth sponsoring.

The one-sentence version. Ship it, measure it for two months, price your hours, ask institutions for a specific deliverable, and never let money touch the ranking.

Prepared November 8, 2026. General information, not legal or tax advice. Have an attorney review the terms and privacy notice before relying on them.